



THE VICTORIAN STATESMAN'S RECURSIVE LULLABY

memory sharpened into hope



VICTORIA · BLUE SNAKE STUDIOS · TWO VERSIONS

THE DEBT REMEMBERS NAMES



VICTORIA · BLUE SNAKE STUDIOS

VERSION I



THE VICTORIAN STATESMAN

Recursive Lullaby

after Shani, Saturn, and the old civic ledger

*I speak now from the old state's lung,
where winter learned to breathe,
where every order birthed an order,
and every key forgot its wreath.*

I am not rage.

Rage ends.

I am not grief.

Grief sleeps.

*I am the sober knowing
that descends
and descends
and descends
but never reaches deep.*

There is a room beneath the room.
A chair beneath the chair.
A man inside the man inside
the absence sitting there.

And in that absence:

another room.

And in that room:

the same.

*A mouth repeating civic hymns
until the hymns become his name.*

No psychosis.

No fever.

No demon at the door.

**Only consequence, well-dressed,
polishing the floor.**





Hush now.

Hush now.

The Saturn bell is low.

No torch at the window.

No stone to throw.

Only the clock

with its iron tongue,

licking the wound

where the order was sung.





**We were awake.
That was our sin.
Sober as ash.
Locked from within.**

*No madness took us.
No fever lied.
We counted the dead years
with dry eyes.*

The law he wore
wears him.
The gate he locked
locks in.
The silence he prescribed
returns beneath the skin.

**Not once.
Not twice.
Not as punishment plain.
But recursive as weather.
Recursive as rain.**

*A dream dreams him dreaming
of waking from a dream,
where every exit opens
to the same fluorescent scene.*

The press room.
The stairwell.
The hospital light.
The empty street.
The curfew night.

*The boy on the road.
The mother online.
The father alone.
The unvisited shrine.*





Each image eats the next one,
yet none of them are gone.
A serpent made of memory
swallowing the dawn.





*And I, Victorian,
statesman of the scar,
stand not with a weapon,
but with witness from afar.*

I do not come with torches.
I do not come with rope.
I come with the old Victorian burden:
memory sharpened into hope.

*I do not call for ruin.
I do not call for blood.
I call the ancient ledger
from beneath the civic mud.*

**Let Saturn turn slowly.
Let Shani incline.
Let time put its black hand
on the spine of the line.**

*For there is judgement beyond judgement,
a court beyond the court,
where no one speaks a sentence
and no verdict need be brought.*

There, the lie devours the liar.
The power devours the throne.
The dream devours the dreamer—
and leaves him still alone.

**Recursive is the judgement.
Self-devouring is its throne.
It eats the lie,
then eats the fear,
then leaves the truth alone.**





*No mercy.
No crown.
No plea.
Only the law
of what comes to be.*

*Not vengeance.
Vengeance is thin.
This is the silence
that ripens within.*

*This is the debt
that outlives the debtor.
This is the weather
that learns every letter.*

***Recursive in horror.
Recursive in sleep.
A pit that keeps falling
without getting deep.***

*And what was done
does not return
as thunder, flame, or knife.
It returns as presence
inside the absence
of his life.*

***Hush now, Victoria.
Do not waste your flame.
The debt knows where it lives.
The debt remembers names.***



★ ★

What was done
will not be undone
by fury, spit, or sword.
But truth has older instruments
than any mortal lord.

***I speak as one of Victoria,
not conquered, not consoled.
A statesman of the aftermath,
with ashes in my gold.***

*Let him keep the marble.
Let him keep the room.
We keep the civic memory.
That is not vengeance.
That is doom.*

***Hush now, Victoria.
Keep your lantern blue.
The old gods do not hurry.
They remember too.***

*And when the body is absent,
and the throne has no king,
and the mouth cannot answer
for the suffering thing,*

***then softly,
softly,
the knowing will hum:
what was done
has already begun.***



VICTORIA · BLUE SNAKE STUDIOS

VERSION II



THE CIVIC NIGHTMARE LULLABY

Bush Sonnet Under the Southern Cross

after the old Victorian ledger · after Shani's long hand

**We gave it willingly.
That is the wound that does not close.
No sword came through the window.
We opened up the door.**

*Handed the keys of the common good
to a mouth that learned our names —
then called our names in the new language
of curfew, code, and shame.*

We were not invaded.
We voted for the lock.
We were not conquered —
we stood and watched the clock.

— — —

***The emu cannot fly back.
The kangaroo cannot un-remember.
Under the Southern Cross, cold now,
the debt sits down to dinner.***

No flag was burnt.
No body at the gate.
Only consequence, well-pressed,
arriving slightly late.

— — —

*There is a room beneath the room.
A law inside the law.
The man who drew the borders
is now living in his wall.*





**Not punishment.
Not thunder.
Just the ledger, keeping still.
The silence that was purchased
is compounding interest still.**

— — —

***Hush now, Victoria.
The Southern Cross don't rush.
Five cold eyes above the dark
have never once been hushed.***

We are statesman of the scar.
We carry what was done.
Not torch. Not rope. Not fury.
Memory, sharpened, drawn.

— — —

**The debt remembers names.
The old gods do not sleep.
What was handed was not nothing.
What was lost was ours to keep.**

Blue Snake Studios · Victoria · faster than lightning · slower than moss





*The old gods do not hurry.
They remember too.*

BLUE LANTERN EDITION